

AUSTRALIA

Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Commonwealth of Australia
Short Form	Australia
Capital	Canberra
Region (UN)	Western European and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Federal parliamentary constitutional monarchy
Head of State	King Charles III (represented by Governor-General Sam Mostyn)
Head of Government	Prime Minister Anthony Albanese
Currency	Australian Dollar (AUD)
UN Member Since	1945 (Founding Member)
MUN Standing	Active middle power; often serves as a bridge between developed and developing nations; emphasizes multilateralism and regional stability.

Recommended Books on Australia's Foreign Policy and UN Engagement

1. **"Fear of Abandonment: Australia in the World Since 1942"** – Allan Gyngell
A comprehensive analysis of Australia's foreign policy decisions and its quest for security and relevance on the global stage.
2. **"Australian Foreign Policy: Controversies and Debates"** – Daniel Baldino et al.
Explores key debates shaping Australia's foreign policy, including its role in the UN and regional dynamics.
3. **"Australia in International Politics: An Introduction to Australian Foreign Policy"** – Derek McDougall

Provides insights into Australia's international relations and its engagement with global institutions.

4. **"The Howard Paradox: Australian Diplomacy in Asia 1996–2006"** – Michael Wesley

Analyzes Australia's diplomatic strategies in Asia during the Howard government era.

5. **"The Tragedy of Australian Foreign Policy"** – Michael Pembroke

Critiques Australia's foreign policy decisions and their implications for national sovereignty.

◆ Source Name	🔗 Link	📌 Why It's Useful (Australia-Specific)
Australia: Beijing + 30 National Review (2024)	Download PDF – UN Women (humanrights.gov.au , unwomen.org , unwomen.org)	Official national review—Australia's first gender equality strategy; provides a full country snapshot across all 12 Beijing areas.
Australian NGO Beijing + 30 Report (2025)	Download PDF – UN Women	Civil society perspective including critiques, progress tracking, and recommendations—adds grassroots depth to official narrative.
CSW69 Preparations (Australia focus)	UN Women CSW69 Prep	Highlights Australia's thematic inputs—care economy, sexual rights, violence prevention—for CSW69.
CSW69 Official Documents Page	UN Women CSW69 Docs	Contains CSW69 agenda, draft declarations, where Australian contributions are visible.
Australia Country Fact Sheet	UN Women Data Hub	Up-to-date gender indicators: 38 % women in parliament, domestic work burden, SDG tracking—quick reference for policy metrics.
World Survey: Social Protection (2024)	Download PDF – UN Women	Includes Australian case studies on social protection reforms and gender resilience—valuable for economic justice discussions.

Gen Equality Accountability Report (2024)	Download PDF – UN Women	Documents Australia's progress under Generation Equality; examples include investments in care infrastructure.
Gender Data Outlook 2024 (Global PDF)	Download PDF	Features gender data capacity, with Australia cited for robust data systems and pay-gap monitoring initiatives.
Gender Data Outlook – At a Glance	Download PDF – highlights	Brief overview—Australia included among advanced countries, helpful for data-focused dialogue.
UN Women Gender Action Lab (Asia-Pacific)	Webpage with AU examples	Showcases Australian-led innovation solutions (e.g., workplace flexibility, gender budgeting tools).
Supporting Participation Program (2024–25)	AUS Human Rights Commission PDF/Word	Funding support for Australians with disability to attend CSW69—highlights domestic inclusion in gender diplomacy.
WGEA – Workplace Gender Equality Agency info	Agency webpage	Australia's statutory gender-equality regulator—mandatory employer reporting on pay gaps, flexible work, violence policies.
ANROWS – Women's Safety Research (2023)	ANROWS website summary	Investigates domestic violence prevention—anchors Australia's evidence-based policy action under UNCSW violence agenda.
CSW69 High-Level Side Event Agenda	Download PDF concept note	Australia co-hosted WPS/YPS side-event—supporting gender and peace/security pillars at CSW.
Australia UN GA Report Submission (2022)	PDF – UN Women	Submission details gender pay gap data (13.8 %), SDG-linked reforms—shows commitment to global standards.
Development Goals: Gender Snapshot (2024)	Download PDF	Australia included in SDG goal-by-goal gender assessments—

		provides comparative metrics across development sectors.
CSW69 Side Event: Future of Care	Webpage – We-Fi event	Features Australia's leadership in care economy discussions; fits UNCSW economic empowerment themes.
World Survey on Gender Roles 2024	UN Women PDF	Intersectional analysis includes Australia on disability inclusion—useful for UNCSW disability and rights dialogues.
UNECE/AP Beijing+30 Regional Report (includes AUS)	Download PDF	Australia featured in Asia-Pacific analysis, linking national actions to regional commitments.

UNIQUE ASPECTS

1. Mandatory Gender Equality Reporting for Employers

Australia is one of the only countries with a **mandatory national employer reporting scheme** through the **Workplace Gender Equality Agency (WGEA)**.

- Employers with 100+ staff must submit annual gender data: pay gaps, leadership representation, flexible work policies, and family violence leave.
- This has made Australia a **global leader in workplace gender transparency**, enabling public accountability and policy benchmarking.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Ties directly into themes of **economic empowerment, workplace equality, and structural reform**.

2. Leadership in Asia-Pacific Gender Diplomacy

Australia plays a **key regional role** in promoting gender equality across the Asia-Pacific through:

- Direct funding to **Pacific Women Lead** programs.
- Co-hosting gender side events at UN forums (e.g. CSW69 focus on care economy).

- Providing technical support for gender statistics across ASEAN and Pacific nations.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Demonstrates Australia's **regional gender diplomacy leadership**, particularly in **South Pacific contexts** often overlooked.

3. National Plan to End Violence Against Women and Children (2022–2032)

This comprehensive 10-year strategy involves:

- \$2.3 billion investment across prevention, early intervention, response, and recovery.
- Strong emphasis on **First Nations women**, LGBTQ+ people, and people with disability.
- Whole-of-government and whole-of-community engagement.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Directly aligns with **Beijing Platform Area D (Violence Against Women)** and SDG 5.2.

4. Disability-Inclusive Gender Policy

Australia actively includes **women with disability** in gender strategies through:

- Funding women with disabilities to attend CSW events.
- Policies developed in consultation with disability rights groups.
- A national roadmap linking disability inclusion to gender equality outcomes.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Exemplifies **intersectional inclusion**, a key evolving focus area for the Commission.

5. Spotlight on First Nations Women

Unique among many Western democracies, Australia centers **Indigenous women** in its gender policies:

- Dedicated **Indigenous Gender Justice Strategy (2024)** under development.

- Recognition of **colonial trauma and systemic disadvantage** in health, justice, and economic participation.
- Programs led **by and for First Nations women** are prioritized in funding.

📌 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Strengthens the “**Leave No One Behind**” principle in SDG 5 and UNCSW resolutions.

6. Gender Pay Gap Transparency & Legislation

In 2023, Australia became one of the first countries to **publicly disclose employer gender pay gaps**, requiring:

- Publication of median pay gaps by employer.
- Year-on-year benchmarking.
- Corrective action plans for persistent gaps.

📌 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Supports economic justice, wage equality, and private-sector accountability.

7. Research-Backed Gender Violence Programs (ANROWS)

The **Australia’s National Research Organisation for Women’s Safety (ANROWS)** generates:

- Data-driven evaluations of interventions (e.g., respectful relationships education).
- Longitudinal studies on violence, mental health, and housing insecurity.
- Tools used globally to inform evidence-based policy.

📌 **Relevance to UNCSW:** One of the only countries with a national gender violence research hub—enabling **evidence-led policy**.

8. STEM Gender Equality via “SAGE” Program

The **Science in Australia Gender Equity (SAGE)** initiative supports universities and research institutions to:

- Achieve gender balance in science and engineering fields.

- Follow Athena SWAN principles adapted for Australia.
- Link government research funding to gender inclusivity.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Direct contribution to **Beijing Platform Area B (Education & Training)**, tackling STEM underrepresentation.

9. Legal Gender Recognition & Protection of LGBTQ+ Women

Australia has advanced LGBTQ+ rights including:

- Marriage equality since 2017.
- Legal recognition of non-binary and trans people in several jurisdictions.
- Specific protections for LGBTQ+ women and girls in anti-discrimination law.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Shows progress on **diverse gender identities and inclusion** in gender equality frameworks.

10. Robust Data Systems for Gender Analysis

Australia is among the world leaders in **gender data collection**, via:

- Integrated ABS (Australian Bureau of Statistics) gender datasets.
- Gender lens applied to national budgets and economic modelling.
- Regular gender audits across policy sectors.

 **Relevance to UNCSW:** Advances **accountability and policy design**, feeding into global SDG and Beijing+30 reporting.
